

An Egg a Day

The compelling campaign of the 1980s, "*Sunday ho ya Monday, roz khao Ande*," seems to have taken a beating. An Indian eats only 43 eggs a year against the prescribed 180 by the National Institute of Nutrition. The number stands at 346 in Japan, 312 in China, while it's 304 in Mexico, reports the National Egg Coordination Committee of India. Not only are eggs rich in vitamins and minerals, but are affordable too. So go for it.



97%

IS THE CURE RATE OF
BREAST CANCER, IF
DETECTED EARLY.

Sweet Relief

If you are in pain, ask for a box of chocolates or a refreshing glass of water. That's the shortest and sweetest route to pain relief, says a new study conducted by researchers at Chicago University, US. Apparently, eating or drinking for pleasure acts as a distraction and hence a natural painkiller—even in the absence of hunger or thirst.

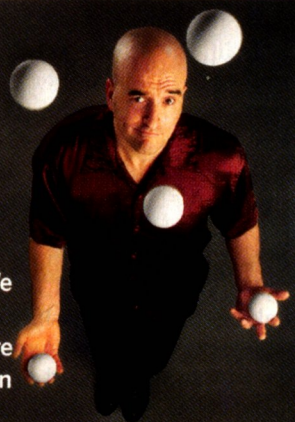


Tie a Pink Ribbon for Better Health

This is breast cancer month. And here's a bit of bracing news for those with breast cancer. For early-stage patients, the worrying question is often: "Will it come back?" A new breast cancer gene test, Mammaprint (okayed for marketing by the USFDA in 2007 and now available in India), can take care of those anxieties. The new technology analyses a small sample of cancer tissue to look at the activity of 70 most informative genes inside a tumour. Even though some tumours appear small and harmless, they can be aggressive. A mammaprint can classify the 'high risk' ones and thus significantly reduce unnecessary chemotherapy, minimise toxicity and the risk of side-effects. Ask your doctor for more information on this test.

Juggling for Brain Power

Forget juggling with life issues. Pick up some balls and start learning the real thing instead. For learning the art of juggling can change the white matter of your brain, claims a study conducted at the Oxford Centre for Functional MRI of the Brain, UK. Published in *Nature Neuroscience*, it shows how connectivity improves in parts of the brain involved in a movement like juggling. We tend to think of the adult brain as being more or less static, but it can update its wiring system to operate more efficiently all the time. New experiences have been shown to change grey matter earlier. This is the first time that white matter enhancement has been demonstrated.



Disconnecting People

The mindscape of the wired world is now the hottest topic of discussion among psychologists. The 24x7 connectivity that today's professionals demand—be it on BlackBerry, iPhone or any other smartphone—is now threatening their personal relationships. Smartphone-triggered divorces are apparently on the rise in many countries. The complainants are mostly women who feel that their husbands are busy checking mails or updating Facebook status or tweeting, oblivious to her or the family's needs.

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta & Anika Mohla**

